OTT

BACK IN THE NEWS

Returning to acting after seven years, **Sonali Bendre** has found in *Broken News* the hope she craves



When Sonali Bendre saw her peers shine in web shows (Sushmita Sen in *Aarya*, Madhuri Dixit in *The Fame Game*, Raveena Tandon in *Aranyak*), she says she felt no real fear of missing out (FOMO). "There was a lot of stuff I didn't want to do," she says. As she kept herself busy with judging TV reality shows, she waited for the right acting gig. It finally came with the role of Amina Qureshi in the series *Broken News* (premiering on Zee5 on June 10), an adaptation of UK TV show *Press* (2018). The Indian version, directed by Vinay Waikul (*The Test Case*, *Aranyak*), transfers the drama from a print newsroom to a TV news studio.

After a hiatus of nearly seven years, *Broken News* ticked all the boxes Bendre had in mind for her comeback. The show, most significantly, wasn't "dark", a genre she wanted to avoid. Her character needed to



FILM

RUNS LIKE A DREAM

As she moves from stage to screen, director **Anamika Haksar** blurs the lines between real and surreal

Theatre director Anamika Haksar is fascinated by dreams. So, when it came to writing her debut feature film, *Ghode Ko Jalebi Khilane Le Ja Riya Hoon*, writing a story with fictional characters wasn't enough. She wanted the people of old Delhi to tell her not just their personal histories but also their dreams. "It is when you know of their dreams that you get into their psyche and know of their subconscious worries or joys," says Haksar.

Haksar put together her repository of dreams with the help of a questionnaire, one that also touched on fears and 'what-if' situations. Shot in 2015-16 and set in old Delhi's Shahjahanabad, *Ghode Ko...* is a film where the lines between the real and the surreal are blurred. Here you see characters flying on a carpet over the old city, dead bodies floating, street